

PH 037: Intro to Philosophy: Happiness, Meaning, Morals

Fall 2026, Claremont McKenna College

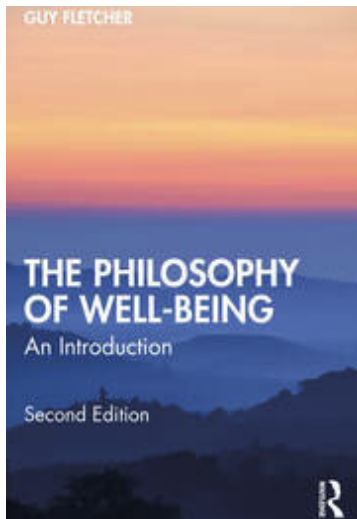
Basic Info / User Guide

I am: Dr. Joseph Frigault (“Friggo”) (he/him)
We meet: M / W mornings in Bauer Center 1 (lower)
My contact is: jfrigault@cmc.edu / 909-607-8474 (office)
My office hours are: Tuesday afternoons (1-3 PM) in Ath 210-H (rooftop)

For your convenience, this Google Doc is equipped with *section tabs* and a *frequently asked questions* (FAQ) section at the end. If ever you have questions about the course, come here *first* for an answer. (Note that emails requesting information that is provided herein may be ignored.)

All policies are subject to revision, so keep this file bookmarked for easy reference. All major changes will be announced in class or over email straightaway.

Course Description



This course explores some of the oldest, most compelling philosophical questions we face: *What is it to live well? What is the meaning of life? How am I to live with others?* We'll divide our investigation of these questions into two units.

In **UNIT 1**, we'll start by asking about *philosophy itself*, and how it relates to the quest for *the good life*. Next, we'll consider how mainstream Anglo-American philosophy has approached the issue of human well-being, by surveying some of the best known *theories of prudential value* it recognizes (presented very ably by Fletcher 2026, left). Our twin aims will be: 1) to *understand* the various classes of theories we consider, both abstractly and through concrete examples, and 2) to *critique* them, that is: to appreciate their various strengths and weaknesses.

In **UNIT 2**, we'll explore how *the good life* is related to and intersects with questions about other kinds of value, like those associated with *meaning* and *morality*. We'll review a range of contemporary materials exploring the idea of assessing lives *holistically*, and have a chance to speak privately with a guest speaker, and former CMC undergrad, who has made important contributions to the literature on this topic.

Along the way, we'll reflect on the question of what has made our own lives good or worthwhile so far, and work to develop the core philosophical skills of argumentative analysis, assessment, and writing. All readings will be provided.

Learning Objectives

The aims of this course are to enable students to:

1. Read dense philosophical texts, and generate questions that further their understanding.
2. Critically analyze and assess complex arguments by determining their structure and identifying the concepts, values, and assumptions that underlie them.
3. Effectively present philosophical ideas and arguments in writing, and articulate objections and counter-arguments to their own views.
4. Reflect on their own intuitive and intellectual views on the issues considered, and demonstrate increased awareness of their nuances and complexity.
5. Approach challenging philosophical problems in a spirit of open and cooperative inquiry, and engage in fruitful and respectful dialogue with others.

By the end of this course, a successful student will be able to:

1. Identify and distinguish a range of key philosophical concepts and categories in value theory (e.g., prudential vs. moral value; happiness vs. meaning in life).
2. Demonstrate knowledge of several prominent approaches to theorizing human well-being (e.g., hedonistic, desire-fulfillment, objective list, and eudaimonistic accounts).
3. Articulate an understanding of some perennial issues in ethics (e.g., the nature of the good life, the meaning of life, and their intersection with the domain of morality).

POLICIES

1. Masking / Food & Drink

Due to health vulnerabilities in my immediate family, I will be masking in class this semester. While you are not required to do so, I invite all students to wear a mask indoors also, and can provide one, if you'd like. Wearing a mask is one small act that protects the most vulnerable among us, as well as those who are caring for family and others in their lives who are vulnerable. If you are feeling unwell, or showing symptoms of illness *please do not come to class*. Instead, seek treatment and rest (see absence policy below for further details).

You are welcome to bring water bottles, to-go cups, and small snack foods to class, and to enjoy them quietly. Larger food items or anything likely to be disruptive, are not permitted.

2. Absences / Lateness

All students are entitled to *two unexcused absences* over the semester; these are your “freebies”. You may use them however you'd like, or not at all. However, every unexcused absence *beyond* your two freebies will result in a grade deduction from your final score in the course (e.g., an A- will become B+; a B+ will become a B, and so on). If you miss class *for any reason* you must send me an *email of explanation* (even if we speak about it together in person). For example, if you intend to use a *freebie*, send me a quick email saying so. If you'd like to request an *excused absence*, send me an email with all relevant information as soon as you are reasonably able. Whatever the reason, please put the phrase “PH 037 ABSENCE” in the subject line. Note that failure to send an email of explanation will register as an unexcused absence.

Requests for excused absences will be judged on a case by case basis, but note that while medical reasons almost always qualify, missing class to spend time with family/friends, or to work on other classes, generally does not. There is no standing requirement to provide a doctor's note for medical absences. In most cases, I'll take your word and call it excused. To prevent abuse of this policy however, I retain the right to make any requested medical absence conditional on the provision of a doctor's note. If you are unable to attend class in person, but would like to join over Zoom, you must alert me by 5 PM on the day *before* the relevant meeting.

Attendance is recorded on a physical attendance sheet which will be laid out for you to sign at the start of each meeting. This should be your first priority when you enter the room. As our meeting begins, I'll collect this sheet, and all subsequent arrivals will register as late. Note that if you are late, it's your responsibility to hang back and *sign the sheet before you leave* so you are not mistakenly counted absent. *Three* unexcused lates will amount to *one* unexcused absence. Similarly, if you are absent, it's your responsibility to catch up on any missed content or announcements made in class, by asking a peer or attending office hours.

3. Email / Office Hours

The two best ways to reach me outside of class are via email or dropping by weekly office hours. Note that I don't *read* or respond to emails outside the hours of 9 AM to 5 PM during the week, and that my aim is to *reply* to all student emails within *one workweek day*. For example, if you write to me on Tuesday at 10:30 AM, I'll try to reply by 10:30 AM on Wednesday. However, if you write to me at 2:00 PM on Friday, I'll aim to reply by 2:00 PM on the following *Monday*. Emails sent over the weekend will be treated as if they were sent at 9:00 AM Monday morning.

Office hours are *drop-in* and there's no need to make an appointment. You may, of course, send an email to let me know when to expect you during office hours, or to request an appointment at an alternate time (for good reason). My preference is to meet on the patio (my office is on the Ath rooftop), but I'm also happy to meet over Zoom.

4. AI Tools / Plagiarism

While AI Tools like ChatGPT can be useful in many contexts, they can also be deeply disruptive in relation to the kinds of learning outcomes philosophers care most about, including developing students' ability to: interpret difficult historical texts; identify the logical structure of arguments written in natural language; and perhaps most importantly, to *think for themselves*. For these reasons, the use of such technology to assist *in any way* with the completion of written work you submit to be graded in this course is *not permitted*. If I discover that you have used such software, you will receive an automatic score of zero on the relevant assignment, and your academic advisor will be notified.

More generally, cheating and plagiarism of any kind will also result in an automatic fail on the relevant assignment, and possibly the course. Please note that I am required to report all cases of *suspected* plagiarism to the Academic Standards Committee. Confirmed cases of cheating or plagiarism may result in suspension from the college. As a student, you are responsible for knowing what plagiarism is, so *ignorance is not an excuse* (see CMC's [Statement of Academic](#)

[Integrity](#) for further info). If ever you are concerned about your performance in the course, or unsure whether or not something counts as plagiarism, please come talk to me about it.

5. Electronics / Testing

All cell phones must be *silenced* and *stowed* for the full duration of class. If I *see* or *hear* your phone, I will ask you to stow it and likely make a note to myself. Similarly, use of laptops, tablets, or other screens in class is *not permitted* unless they lay flat on the surface of the table, and are used exclusively for viewing electronic copies of the reading or taking notes. Barring any special accommodations, the only other exceptions to this policy will be: 1) our Midterm and Final Exam meetings, when you will be asked to bring your personal laptop to class, equipped with *Electronic Bluebook* software (if you do not have a personal computer, one will be provided for you), and 2) our final class meeting where you will complete course evaluations online.

EXPECTATIONS

1. Format / Note Taking

This is a discussion-based course, which means that the majority of our in-class time will be devoted to talking things over in one way or another, whether in small groups or all together. There will be *no formal lectures* in which I speak at length while students quietly take notes. That doesn't mean you don't have to take notes - *you definitely do* - but I recommend thinking of these less as an attempt to take down an objective record of "the class content" which should be the same for everyone, and more as a kind of living document aimed at helping to keep track of your actual engagement with the material: a *personalized record* of your understanding of things, as it stands on a given day, which you can work from and develop as the term goes on.

2. Group Work / Norms

Most days, we'll divide into randomized groups of three or four to discuss some prepared questions or conduct an in-class exercise designed to help you think more deeply about the texts. These activities will usually take 5 to 15 minutes, after which we'll talk things over as a class. Weather-permitting group work will take place outdoors. There are a couple of reasons for this. First, moving around can help to shake up our thinking. Second, the smaller scale also allows you to speak a bit more candidly with one another about the material, comparing your impressions and flagging things you found interesting or challenging to then discuss as a class.

Since most of what we do in the philosophy classroom is talk, it's important for us to give careful thought to how we should go about doing that. Take a minute to check out [this document](#), prepared by a professional philosopher at Rutgers, for some useful advice on how to be a good discussion peer. Read it carefully, and let it inform your approach to our classroom discussions. Let me know if you think anything should be added to this list and we can discuss it as a class.

This course covers some topics that can be uncomfortable to think about and discuss openly (e.g., What is the meaning of life? Is there one?). If you have concerns about encountering anything specific in our material and would like me to provide warnings, please get in touch. I will strive to make our class a welcoming and comfortable space for all, and I ask that you join me in this, especially in small group discussions where I am not present. Sensitivity and respect are

particularly important in relation to matters involving race, color, national origin, sex, pregnancy, age, disability, creed, religion, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, veteran status, political affiliation, political philosophy, or any other aspect of personal identity. Note, for example, that people from marginalized groups will not be expected to speak on behalf of their group as a whole. Good class citizenship also involves addressing one's peers by their stated name and pronouns. That includes myself and any guests, whether in person or over Zoom, and in all online interactions. Some disrespectful behaviors, when egregious or repeated, may be penalized. For example, aggressive or dominating behavior; returning late (or not at all) from group discussions outside; ignoring/talking over fellow students; or nodding off in class may result in a grade deduction from your final score (I'll reach out with a warning first).

3. Discussion Priorities

Many of the readings in this class are very rich in content, and there is *no standing expectation* that we will be able to cover all of the interesting ideas they contain, or possible interpretations they might be given. This means that we will have to be *selective* in what we choose to focus on. While a central goal of my prepared questions and exercises is to signal what I think of as the most *important* aspects of the material, and those which are most likely to be *tested*, this does not mean that our in-class discussions must be limited to that material. For example, sometimes the class will feel it has a good grasp on those central aspects, and will want to pursue other dimensions of the reading. This is great, as long as it helps improve our collective grasp of the reading and/or its relation to the rest of our course materials. If it doesn't, or if I judge that our adventures are leading us too far afield, I'll re-direct our discussions back to more central parts of the content. (Note that more distant topics can always be picked up with me in office hours.)

Generally speaking, our procedure will be to start by working to *understand* the material before *critiquing* or *assessing* it, for what I hope are obvious reasons. That said, these two philosophical tasks often overlap and complement each other; you may not be able to really grasp the force of an argument or theory until you appreciate how it can accommodate what you thought was a devastating criticism. So we may toggle around a bit too.

4. Role Responsibilities

Beyond our shared responsibility to be good class citizens and help maintain an appropriate learning environment, students and instructors have additional role responsibilities that should guide our conduct. For example, my role as instructor includes, among others, a responsibility to:

1. come to class prepared to help students engage with the material;
2. address all (relevant and appropriate) student questions to the best of my ability, and if and when I'm unable to do so, following up with the class later on;
3. see to it that all (relevant and appropriate) student opinions and contributions are given a fair hearing, and that important points of view are not overlooked; and
4. ensure that the views of the authors we consider are given a full and adequate defense.

Note that fulfilling these responsibilities may mean elaborating and defending positions that I myself do not hold, or holding space for student contributions which I (or others in the room)

may think are mistaken, or even offensive, so long as they are not distracting, hurtful, or otherwise ill-advised. Similarly, your role as student also involves the responsibility to:

1. do the assigned readings in a manner that conduces to one's comprehension (i.e., not trying to skim them in the last few moments before class begins);
2. bring a copy of the reading to class for reference in our discussions (hard copies preferred, but e-copies permitted; see "Electronics / Testing" above);
3. take an active role in your own learning by raising questions or confusions encountered in your reading, responding to peer comments, and following the conversation;
4. get in touch with me if ever you have concerns about our shared classroom experience;
5. make appropriate use of the institutional resources available to you (see below).

If you have questions or concerns about any of these responsibilities or feel you have a compelling reason for an exemption from any of preceding ground rules, please get in touch.

5. Support Resources

College life puts a lot of pressure on students, and the academic (and wider cultural) environment emphasizing individualism and "pulling yourself up by your bootstraps" can disincentivize asking for help, and even make it hard to realize or admit that we may need it. I encourage you to let me know if there is any issue you feel is impeding your full participation in our class. More generally, you are encouraged to familiarize yourself with the many forms of student support available to you at the Claremont colleges.

- The [Romero Success Coach program](#) is an important peer-to-peer resource on campus. They are here to help develop well-being, academic, and life skills, as well as strategies with you to achieve your goals. Meet with a Romero Success Coach (RSC) to talk through time management and organization, overcoming procrastination and test anxiety, efficient reading and note-taking, and exam prep. They can also help with goal-setting and habit-building, streamlining workflow, sleep management, stress-tolerance and coping skills, and other important aspects of your holistic well-being. RSCs hold appointments in person and offer open drop-in hours. Once you make an appointment through the [platform](#), the Success Coach will reach out to confirm.
- The Center for Writing and Public Discourse (CWPD) aids students from all disciplines at any point during the writing process. Consultants work with students, one-on-one, to look over drafts, help organize ideas, and provide advice that can help students become stronger writers. CWPD consultants also provide feedback on oral presentations and general guidance regarding speaking skills. Students can sign up for a consultation [here](#).
- If you have a disability and have already been approved by CMC Accessibility Services to receive accommodations, please forward your eligibility letter to me so we can discuss their implementation in this course. If you have not yet established accommodations through Accessibility Services, but have a disability (qualifying conditions may include, but are not limited to: mental health, attention-related, learning, vision, hearing, or other physical or health related impairments), you are encouraged to contact [Accessibility Services](#) to learn more about available accommodations and/or initiate the process.

General information, including information about requesting accommodations, may also be found on the [CMC Accessibility Services website](#). Students may apply for accommodations from CMC Accessibility Services at any point in the semester. Please keep in mind that the process takes time to complete, and accommodations are not retroactive. In addition, please note that accommodations do not become effective for this course until you have forwarded me your eligibility letter from CMC Accessibility Services. Claremont McKenna College is committed to creating an inclusive and accessible learning environment consistent with federal and state law. If you are not a CMC student, please contact the Disability/Accessibility Services Coordinator on your campus regarding a similar process.

- If you are seeking confidential support, contact a confidential support provider such as the Director of the [EmPOWER Center](#), the Director of the [Queer Resource Center](#) (QRC), counselors at [Monsour Counseling and Psychological Services](#) (MCAPS), medical staff at the [Student Health Center](#), and the [The Claremont Colleges Chaplains](#). Note that as CMC faculty, I am a “responsible employee,” meaning that if I am made aware of potential discrimination, harassment, misconduct, or violence that has occurred involving any CMC student, staff, or faculty member, I am required by law to report it to the [Title IX Administrator](#).

EVALUATION

Prep Work & Engagement (50%)

In-Class Examinations (50%)



1. Dailies (20%)

Dailies are the basic unit of homework for the course and are assigned, as the name implies, for nearly all our meetings (20 or so at ~1% each). They are short written responses to the reading designed to help you practice philosophical engagement (if multiple readings are assigned, you may write on any one or more, consistent with the prompts below). Your Dailies are completed in two steps: one part is completed on your own *before* you come to class, and the other is completed *during* class, and may draw on our small group and full class discussions.

Unless otherwise noted, the prompts for the two parts are the same every time, as follows:

PART 1 (completed *before* class)

- Flag** Identify some aspect of the reading you find interesting or confusing and *describe* it as if to an unfamiliar audience. Give a page and location e.g., (p. 150, top).
- Reflect** Take a minute to consider what it is about this aspect of the reading that makes it stand out to you in this particular way. Then state that, as succinctly as you can.
- Evaluate** Now, try to *weigh-in* on something discussed in the reading. You can agree or disagree; just make your judgment clear, and explain it. (If it's the same topic you've been discussing, go beyond what's already been said.)
- Anticipate** How would someone who disagrees with your evaluation likely respond? Try to support your remarks here with evidence from the text itself.

PART 2 (completed *during* class)

- A-Ha!** Something you learned or realized in discussion; give all relevant details.
- Peer Insight** Something a fellow student said or asked in class that you found worthy of note. (A simple quotation here is fine, but be sure to *give their name*.)
- Sticky Issue** A question or confusion that's still bugging you after our discussion.

Responses to each prompt needn't be more than a few lines, and your Daily as a whole is not to exceed one page (single-sided). Note that Dailies must be completed *by hand on an 8 x 11" sheet of scrap paper* (provided), done up more or less like [this](#). We'll set aside 5 minutes or so at the end of each session for you to finish up the in-class portion and hand them in as you leave.

Dailies are scored for completion (pass / not-pass). *Completion* means that you have responded to all seven of the prompts; that your responses actually do what is asked; and that they show good engagement. For example, if part of your response is too curt (e.g., "What does X mean?") or superficial (e.g., "This reading was cool. I liked it a lot."), it will receive a score of not-pass. Similarly, if your submission is unreadable (e.g., because composed quickly or without due care), it may also be a not-pass. Other ways to earn a not-pass include (but are not limited to): submitting them on material not assigned that day (e.g., a reading for the next period); submitting them on something other than scrap paper (e.g., on a napkin, or by email); submitting them late (e.g., the following day, or even an hour after class).

If you fail to submit a Daily due to an *excused absence* (e.g., for medical reasons), or using one of your *freebies*, that score will be *suppressed from your total*. This means that each of the other Dailies will make up a slightly larger percentage of the 20% (e.g., 1.1% instead of 1%). Dailies missed due to *unexcused absences* will be awarded a score of not-pass. Dailies will be returned to you as soon as possible, sometimes with light comments, and should be retained for your reference, and for your monthly reviews.

2. Monthlies (15%)

Monthlies are short written reports which you will prepare and submit at the end of each full month on the course (Sep, Oct, Nov; 5% each). These reports will ask you to review the Dailies you have completed for that month, and respond to several questions (to be provided a week in advance). The idea here is to give you a chance to look back over your engagement with the readings so far and to reflect on them in various ways, for example: on what has or has not been working for you; which ideas or readings have had the biggest impression on your thinking; whether there are any patterns or lessons that can be observed in looking over your regular homework (e.g., increased class participation helps with retention of ideas).

Like your Dailies, these Monthly reports are not to exceed one page (single-sided), and must be completed *by hand on an 8 x 11" sheet of scrap paper*, done up more or less like [this](#). They must be submitted *along with the Dailies themselves* (stapled or paper clipped together), so that I can track your references to specific passages. Unlike your Dailies, Monthlies must be completed wholly individually, and outside of class time. They will be scored out of 15 points, as follows:

Form	Does your report meet all formal requirements and address all questions? Does it contain at least two references to your Dailies?	5 points
Clarity	Would your discussion of all class materials be intelligible to someone wholly unfamiliar with them?	5 points
Engagement / Competence	Does your report show a sincere attempt to track / assess your progress, and a competent grasp of our course materials?	5 points

3. Participation (15%)

Contributions to small group discussions, and cooperation during other sorts of in-class exercises are obviously crucial for the success of all, but these pose problems for scoring directly. For our purposes, therefore, *participation* refers to verbal contributions to our *full class discussions*. Examples include: asking or answering a question; sharing a thought about the readings; responding to someone else's contribution, and the like. Each meeting I take note of who contributes in this way and keep a tally as the term goes on. This purely quantitative data (# of sessions where you made at least one contribution) largely determines your participation score.

Obviously, quality and frequency of verbal contributions matters too, but these are secondary, and I strongly discourage withholding questions or comments they think are "not good enough." There are several reasons for this. First, contributions that may seem obvious or meaningless to you may hold great value for others, even if it is just the sense of confirmation that comes with learning that someone else was thinking about what they had in mind. Second, ideas that may seem irrelevant or fruitless very often lead somewhere interesting, but only if they are raised.

Note that it is *your responsibility* to make sure your in-class contributions get made each day. Unless a student explicitly requests that I call on them from time to time, I will not do so. Occasionally, I will call on students if I know for sure that they have something to add to our

discussion (e.g., if their recent Dailies have contained awesome insights on the topic at hand). I recommend thinking of your Dailies as a way to prepare for in-class discussion by generating material for contributions in advance.

Participation will be scored in *three chunks* (5% each), one for roughly each month of the course (Aug/Sep; Oct; and Nov/Dec). While there's no strict formula for computing participation scores, the following examples should help guide your interpretation of your scores:

	0	1	2	3	4	5
In-Class Behavior	Not interested in others' views or comments. Checked out of discussion most sessions.	Listens attentively and adds occasional brief comments (e.g., every 3 sessions).	Speaks up often (e.g., half the time or so), but mainly in response to others.	Speaks up reliably (e.g., two thirds of the time) with a comment or question.	Listens actively and adds something meaningful to almost every class session.	Contributes every period, with respectful questions and astute comments.

4. Midterm Exam (20%)

This will be a sit-down, closed-book, in-class exam designed to assess your ability to *articulate*, *critically evaluate*, and *compare* the three major theories of well-being we consider unit 1, along with the other more historical materials. Further details and a study guide will be provided.

5. Final Exam (30%)

This will be a sit-down, closed-book exam, held during the exam period, designed to assess your understanding of the various issues and materials we discuss in unit 2. Questions will vary in format, but note that it will contain at least one *long-answer* question which invites you to *articulate*, *critically evaluate*, and *compare* the major arguments from our course materials. Further details and a study guide will be provided.

Letter grade cut-offs (with correlate grade points according to [CMC's Official Grading System](#)):

A+ = N/A	A = 93 - 100 (4.00)	A- = 90 - 92.99... (3.67)
B+ = 87 - 89.99... (3.33)	B = 83 - 86.99... (3.00)	B- = 80 - 82.99... (2.67)
C+ = 77 - 79.99... (2.33)	C = 73 - 76.99... (2.00)	C- = 70 - 72.99... (1.67)
D+ = 67 - 69.99... (1.33)	D = 63 - 66.99... (1.00)	D- = 60 - 62.99... (0.67)
	F = below 60 (0.00)	

SCHEDULE

UNIT 1: Philosophy & Well-Being: <i>Theories of Prudential Value</i>		
DATE	TOPIC + READING (rough page count)	ASSIGNMENTS + REMINDERS
Monday, Aug 31	<u>Welcome & Orientation</u> Review Course Syllabus	
Wednesday, Sep 2	<u>What is philosophy?</u> Plato, <i>Euthyphro</i> (~14 pgs)	Daily 1
Monday, Sep 7	NO CLASS: Labor Day	
Wednesday, Sep 9	<u>Hedonistic Theories</u> (analyze) Fletcher, Intro + Ch. 1, §1.1-1.2 (~12 pgs)	Daily 2
Monday, Sep 14	<u>Hedonistic Theories</u> (critique) Fletcher, Ch. 1, §1.3-1.4 (~10 pgs)	Daily 3 Last day to <i>add</i> classes.
Wednesday, Sep 16	<u>Hedonistic Theories</u> (engage) Epicurus + Mill (~14 pgs)	Daily 4
Monday, Sep 21	<u>Desire-Fulfillment Theories</u> (analyze) Fletcher, Ch 2, §2.1-2.2 (~7 pgs)	Daily 5
Wednesday, Sep 23	<u>Desire-Fulfillment Theories</u> (critique) Fletcher, Ch. 2, §2.3-2.8 (~12 pgs)	Daily 6
Monday, Sep 28	<u>Desire-Fulfillment Theories</u> (engage) Heathwood (~11 pgs)	Daily 7 Monthly 1 instructions posted.
Wednesday, Sep 30	<u>Objective List Theories</u> (analyze) Fletcher, Ch. 3, §3.1-3.2 (~6 pgs)	Daily 8
Monday, Oct 5	<u>Objective List Theories</u> (critique) Fletcher, Ch. 3, §3.3-3.4 (~8 pgs)	Daily 9 Monthly 1 due at the start of class. Bring your laptop for a dry run of EBB.
Wednesday, Oct 7	<u>Objective List Theories</u> (engage) Kazez (~12 pgs)	Daily 10 Academic Advisory Notice target date.
Monday, Oct 12	<u>Wrap-Up & Midterm Prep</u>	Bring your study questions.
Wednesday, Oct 14	Midterm (20%)	Usual classroom; usual time. Bring your laptop (test is on EBB).
October 17 - 20	NO CLASS: Fall Break	

UNIT 2: Meaning & Morals: <i>Drawing It All Together</i>		
DATE	TOPIC + READING (rough page count)	ASSIGNMENTS + REMINDERS
Wednesday, Oct 21	<u>The Shape of a Life</u> Fletcher, Ch. 8 (~12 pgs)	Daily 11 Last day to <i>drop</i> : Thurs, Oct 22.
Monday, Oct 26	<u>Lunch Session with Dr. Amy Berg (12:00-1:00 PM)</u> To discuss her new book <i>The Well-Rounded Life</i> .	Dr. Berg will also be speaking at the Ath on Monday evening (5:30-8:00 PM). Monthly 2 instructions posted.
Wednesday, Oct 28	<u>Do good lives make good stories?</u> Berg 2023, Part 1 (XXX pgs)	Daily 12
Monday, Nov 2	<u>Do good lives make good stories?</u> Berg 2023, Part 2 (XXX pgs)	Daily 13 Monthly 2 due at the start of class. Spring 2027 courses visible online.
Wednesday, Nov 4	<u>A Reply to Berg</u> Kauppinen 2024 (~14 pgs)	Daily 14
Monday, Nov 9	<u>What is Meaninglessness?</u> Taylor 1970 (~9 pgs)	Daily 15
Wednesday, Nov 11	<u>Meaning & The Good Life</u> Wolf 1997, Part 1 (XXX pgs)	Daily 16
Monday, Nov 16	<u>Meaning & The Good Life</u> Wolf 1997, Part 2 (XXX pgs)	Daily 17
Wednesday, Nov 18	<u>Consequentialism about Meaning in Life</u> Bramble 2015, Part 1 (XXX pgs)	Daily 18 Last day to <i>withdraw</i> : Fri, Nov 20.
Monday, Nov 23	<u>Consequentialism about Meaning in Life (02)</u> Bramble 2015, Part 2 (XXX pgs)	Daily 19
Wednesday 25	NO CLASS: Thanksgiving	
Monday, Nov 30	<u>Morality & The Good Life</u> Wolf 1982, Part 1 (XXX pgs)	Daily 20 Monthly 3 instructions posted.
Wednesday, Dec 2	<u>Morality & The Good Life</u> Wolf 1982, Part 2 (XXX pgs)	Daily 21
Monday, Dec 7	<u>Wrap-Up & Final Prep</u> Day 1: Fletcher, Berg, Kauppinen	Bring your study questions. writing prep / exercises? Monthly 3 due at the start of class.

Wednesday, Dec 9	<u>Wrap-Up & Final Prep</u> Day 2: Wolf, Bramble, Wolf	Bring your study questions. Bring your laptop. (evaluations)
Date: TBD	Final Exam (30%)	Time + Location: TBD Bring your laptop (test is on EBB).
Thursday, Dec 24	Grades Due to Registrar	
Wednesday, Jan 6	Grades Visible on the Portal	

FAQ

- 1. Do I need to make an appointment to come speak with you during office hours?**
No. Office hours are drop-in, so just go ahead and stop by.
- 2. I didn't have time to do the readings for today. Should I still come to class?**
Absolutely. There's no penalty for failing to do the reading on time, and nothing to gain by opting out of our in-class discussions. Showing up and doing your best to follow along and take part is in everyone's best interests.
- 3. Why did I get a *not-pass* (X) on my Daily?**
Most likely because your submission ran afoul of some element of the criteria. Take another look at the section on "Dailies" above to confirm.
- 4. I didn't complete my Daily because (*insert explanation*). Can I still get credit for it?**
No. Dailies are submitted at the end of each meeting and there are no exceptions. See the section on "Dailies" above for full details.
- 5. I'm having a hard time with the readings. Should I use the internet to help?**
I advise against it. A lot of what's online is dubious, and since evaluation will be tailored to our in-class activities, even good sources may be misleading. I recommend coming into office hours; I've got some strategies that can help.
- 6. I'm having a hard time with in-class discussion. What should I do?**
It depends on the nature of the difficulty. I recommend coming into office hours, and we will do our best to figure out a solution that works for you.
- 7. I'm having a hard time studying for exams. What should I do?**
The best way to prepare for exams is to do what we do in class all semester long: 1) read and talk about the material, with your peers or with me in office hours, and 2) work to improve your comprehension by reviewing the notes you took in the course of our discussions (note that this may mean *revising* them). Since exams involve showing your understanding in writing under time pressure, I also recommend that you 3) practice responding to mock questions, with a timer, to simulate the actual conditions of the test.
- 8. I'm disappointed with my grade on (*insert assignment*). Can I make it up somehow?**
No. There are no make-up assignments, or extra credit. In the meantime, if you're looking for ways to curry favor with me, I recommend:

- 1) Attending one of the public lectures hosted by the philosophy department (making sure I see you) and/or chatting with me about it afterward.
- 2) Getting some students together and inviting me to throw the frisbee around.

9. I think my grade on (*insert assignment*) is too low. Will you regrade it?

I don't generally re-grade whole assignments, but if you feel I have made a mistake grading some part of your work, please get in touch with me to discuss it. This should be done as soon as possible though: the longer you wait to bring it up, the less likely it is that anything can be done.